■ React Native Student Handout

Run Your App on Mobile + Build APK

PART A — View Your React Native App on Your Phone (Expo)

1. Install Required Tools

On Laptop:

• Node.js (LTS)

• Visual Studio Code

• Expo CLI: npm install --global expo-cli

On Mobile:

• Install Expo Go from Play Store / App Store

2. Open Your Project

• Open VS Code → File → Open Folder

• Open Terminal → Terminal → New Terminal

3. Install Dependencies

npm install

(or yarn install)

4. Start the Expo Server

npx expo start

A QR code will appear.

5. Run the App on Your Phone

Laptop + Mobile must be on same WiFi.

Method 1 — Scan QR Code

• Open Expo Go → Scan QR Code → Scan

Method 2 — Expo Login

• Log in on Expo Go + browser → App appears under Projects

6. Live Reload

Save → App reloads instantly in Expo Go.

PART B — Build an APK (Android)

1. Install EAS

npm install -g eas-cli

2. Log in

eas login

3. Configure Project

eas build:configure

4. Build APK

eas build -p android --profile preview --local

APK saved in: /builds/

Alternative (Bare Workflow)

Use only if project is ejected:

cd android

./gradlew assembleDebug

APK path:

android/app/build/outputs/apk/debug/app-debug.apk

Quick Summary

View App:

• Install Expo Go

• npm install

• npx expo start

• Scan QR

Build APK:

• Install EAS

• eas login

• eas build -p android --profile preview --local

Happy Coding! Bring your questions to class.